

STAGE FOUR • MINDSET, PRODUCTIVITY & HABITS

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Four, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if none of the productivity systems in this stage actually fit how I work?

A: Adapt them. The specific structure (a 3-part confidence routine, a 25-minute focus block) is a starting template, not a rigid rule. What matters is that you leave with something you'll genuinely use, even if it's a modified version of what's suggested.

Q2. What if I've tried habits like this before and they never stick?

A: That's an extremely common experience, and this stage is designed with that in mind — particularly FIRST E14 (Habit Stacking), which addresses one of the most common reasons habits fail: trying to remember them from scratch each day instead of attaching them to something you already do reliably.

Q3. Do I actually have to do a side project, volunteer work, AND get a certification?

A: No — Stage Four's Extra Edge FIRSTS are meant to help you identify which of these genuinely fits your situation and goals, not to prescribe doing all of them. Depth in one or two beats a thin, obligatory attempt at all five.

Q4. What if I don't have a strong opinion for the Thought Leadership Post (FIRST F5)?

A: Start smaller than you think you need to. A genuine, specific observation from your own experience (“I've noticed X pattern in Y context”) counts as a real opinion. It doesn't need to be a bold, controversial take to be worth sharing.

Q5. Is it okay if my gratitude practice or affirmations feel awkward at first?

A: Yes, and that's genuinely normal. Like the confidence routine, these tend to feel most artificial in the first week and more natural with repetition. Push through the initial awkwardness before deciding whether a practice genuinely works for you.

Q6. What if I'm going through something genuinely difficult right now and this all feels like too much?

A: Please talk to your facilitator directly. This stage's tools are meant to support real capacity, not add pressure on top of a genuinely hard time. Some FIRSTS may be worth revisiting later rather than forcing right now.